

Competing tools in mixed signal electronic circuit simulation

GNU circuit analysis package (GNUCAP). GNUCAP is a fully-interactive and command-driven general-purpose circuit simulator, developed as part of GNU project. It can perform non-linear DC and transient analysis, Fourier analysis and AC analysis linearised at an operating point.

Ngspice. Ngspice is yet another open source mixed signal circuit simulator. It is possible to have three classes of analyses using Ngspice—non-linear DC analysis, non-linear transient analysis and linear AC analysis.

Easyeda. Easyeda is a web based EDA tool for electronics engineers. This is an online tool and the user need not download any software. Easyeda helps in online schematic capture, PCB design and Ngspice simulation.

Falstad circuit simulator applet. Circuit simulator is a freely available Java applet that can be used to simulate a wide variety of electrical and electronic circuits. We can either run the simulator as a standalone Java application or embedded within a web page by using a Java-enabled browser.

GeckoCIRCUITS. GeckoCIRCUITS is a circuit simulator for modelling power electronic systems. The software has an extremely-high simulation speed. It can be used to simulate control modelling and thermal simulations. It can also be integrated into MATLAB/Simulink or other programming environments.

Another user from apps.ubuntu.com says, "I have only played with this briefly, but if you are familiar with Agilent Design System (ADS), then you will pretty much be right at home. That being said, if you are not familiar with ADS, then it could be a bit confusing. Features included are: AC, DC, harmonic balance, S parameter sims, Smith charts, as well as cartesian plots for transient sims, SPICE models for transistors and FETs, and file based circuit elements. It looks like it will be adequate for hobby circuit building. In fact, it is probably the most complete open source circuit simulator that I have found."

Why not give it a try

Qucs is already a very popular electronic circuit simulator among design engineers. It is free and an open source simulator. If you are a designer or student who is curious to know how a circuit works, you must give it a try today itself. ●

The author works at Efy

users are quite impressed with this product.

A user from sourceforge.net writes, "This is a very nice product. I am a DSP guy, so I do not use circuit simulators often. I have some experience with SPICE and OrCAD, but

I have a very strong preference for Qucs. It is easier to use and richer in features. For example, the basic OpAmp is just what you need when you want to make some examples in class without drowning in the complexities of a real OpAmp."

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